

Inventory types and status changes

Retail, wholesale, distribution, trading, material supplier, equipment, and general.

All seven inventory types run on the same stock, purchase, and sales engines. The profile you pick in Settings describes the kind of business you are. It changes labels and demo data. It does not change status names or lock you out of Issue, Sales, or Procurement.

Demo password for every seeded user: Test@1234. Log in at /login after pnpm run dev from the repo root.

At a glance

What changes by type	Industry label, catalog examples, and (for material suppliers) Materials / Indent wording.
What does not change	Statuses, stock issue, sales order to challan to invoice, PO to GRN to bill, warehouses, GST invoices.
Where to set it	Inventory -> Settings -> Business profile (OWNER). Takes effect after save / refresh.
Construction ERP	Separate product (not an inventory type). Projects, BOQ, subcontracts.

The one wording split

MATERIAL_SUPPLIER keeps construction-style words. Every other inventory type uses generic trading words. Buttons and statuses are identical.

Profile	Catalog tab	Purchase request	Store
Material supplier	Materials	Indent / Indents	Store
All other types	Items	Purchase request(s)	Store

1. The seven inventory types

Pick the profile that matches how you describe the business. You can change it later.

Retail store (RETAIL)

Best for	Counter / shop sales in small quantities (hardware, electrical, finishing).
Typical catalog	PVC fittings, bulbs, wall putty - piece and bag SKUs.
How they sell	Mostly Stock -> Issue (walk-in). Formal sales order when a contractor wants a billed order.
Demo login	owner@cityhardware.com - City Hardware Retail

Wholesale / cash & carry (WHOLESALE)

Best for	Bulk boxes and rims sold to shops and offices, often same-day pickup.
Typical catalog	Cartons, rims, packing tape - higher opening quantities.
How they sell	Mix of Issue (cash counter) and Sales order + dispatch for billed wholesale lots.
Demo login	owner@deccanwholesale.com - Deccan Wholesale Mart

Distributor / stockist (DISTRIBUTION)

Best for	Brand or spare-parts stockist supplying dealers; often more than one warehouse later.
Typical catalog	Auto / spare SKUs (belts, filters, pad sets).
How they sell	Prefer Sales order -> challan -> dispatch so each dealer shipment has a DC and draft invoice.
Demo login	owner@southdistro.com - South Distro Spares

Trader / trading company (TRADING)

Best for	Buy-and-sell of commodities (steel, pipes, sheets) by weight or metre.
Typical catalog	MS angle, GI pipe, CR sheet - kg / m units, large on-hand balances.
How they sell	Purchase (indent -> PO -> GRN) then sell via Sales order or Issue depending on whether goods leave today.
Demo login	owner@apextrading.com - Apex Trading Co

Material supplier (MATERIAL_SUPPLIER)

Best for	Cement, steel, sand, bricks sold to sites. Closest to construction store language.
Typical catalog	OPC cement, TMT, sand, bricks, aggregate. Richest demo: 2 warehouses, parties, price list.
Wording	Materials / Indent (not Items / Purchase request). Tab label is Materials.
How they sell	Site pickup -> Issue. Site delivery -> Sales order + dispatch + challan PDF.
Demo login	owner@hydmaterials.com (also manager@hydmaterials.com)

Equipment dealer / rental (EQUIPMENT)

Best for	Stocking plant and access equipment rather than consumable bags.
Typical catalog	Mixer, vibrator, scaffold sets - catalog type EQUIPMENT, high unit rates, low qty.
Note	Status machines are still the same. This is not a rental calendar / hire module.
How they sell	Usually Sales order + dispatch (high value). Issue is available for walk-in cash sale.
Demo login	owner@forgeequip.com - Forge Equipment Dealers

General business (GENERAL)

Best for	Default when the business does not fit the others. Same full inventory product.
Typical catalog	Mixed SKUs (fasteners, PPE). Safe starting profile.
How they sell	Use Issue if they take goods now, or a sales order if you ship later.
Demo login	owner@generalstore.com - General Goods Store

What is the same for every type

- Stock, Procurement, Sales, Warehouse, Parties, Invoices, Bills, Settings, Tally export.
- GST draft invoices on stock issue and on challan dispatch.
- Credit-limit policy (Allow / Warn / Block) and PO approval thresholds - company settings, not profile-specific.
- Barcode identify, stock adjustments, transfers, stock counts, quotes, returns, credit/debit notes.

2. Two ways to sell (every type)

This is the difference operators feel day to day. It is not tied to retail vs wholesale - any profile can use both.

A. Issue (Stock or item screen)

Walk-in / counter sale. Goods leave now.



- No confirm, no challan, no deliver step.
- Sales list shows it as Counter sale from stock issue - already invoiced.
- Confirm the draft on Sales invoices (DRAFT -> SENT) then record payment (SENT -> PAID).

B. Sales order (Sales screen)

Order first, ship later. Creating the order does not move stock.



- Dispatch is the moment stock leaves - same as Issue for inventory, plus a delivery challan.
- After dispatch the sales order is INVOICED and a draft invoice exists. Deliver only marks customer received.
- Use this when you need a challan PDF, a named customer, or goods leave on another day.

When to use which

Situation	Use
Customer at the counter today	Issue
Order now, send tomorrow / to site	Sales order -> challan -> dispatch
Need a quote first	Quote -> accept -> sales order
Need proof of dispatch	Sales order path (challan PDF)
Retail / wholesale cash	Usually Issue
Distributor / equipment / site delivery	Usually Sales order

3. Status changes (shared by all types)

Statuses do not differ by inventory type. Forward-only unless noted.

Sales order



Cancel is allowed from CONFIRMED or DELIVERED (not after INVOICED). Counter sales from Issue are created already INVOICED.

- DRAFT -> Confirm.
- CONFIRMED -> Create challan. After full dispatch the order becomes DELIVERED, then auto-invoiced -> INVOICED.
- INVOICED -> Go to invoices (no second stock OUT).

Quote



SENT can also be Rejected. Accepted quotes convert to a sales order.

Delivery challan



- DRAFT -> Dispatch (stock OUT from the chosen warehouse; draft invoice if linked to a sales order).
- DISPATCHED -> Deliver (acknowledgement only).
- Cancel only while still DRAFT (before stock has moved).

Sales invoice (AR)



- Created as DRAFT from Issue, from dispatch, or manually.
- Confirm / Send -> SENT. Past due date while unpaid -> OVERDUE.
- Record payment -> PAID when the balance is cleared. Partial payments stay SENT/OVERDUE until fully paid.

Purchase request / Indent -> PO -> GRN



- Inventory indents are created already approved so you can raise a PO immediately.
- PO status: DRAFT / SUBMITTED / APPROVED (and REJECTED if declined).
- Auto-approve below the first Rs threshold; manager band in the middle; owner only above the second. Both 0 = always auto-approve.
- GRN brings stock IN and creates a draft vendor bill. Then go to Vendor bills.

Vendor bill (AP)



- GRN bills start as DRAFT. Confirm / Approve -> APPROVED. Reject -> REJECTED.
- Record payment on an approved bill -> PAID (or remain APPROVED if partially paid).
- PENDING appears for bills that still need approval in the construction-style flow.

Warehouse transfer



- Create transfer (only items on hand at the source warehouse).
- Dispatch -> IN_TRANSIT (stock leaves source).
- Receive -> RECEIVED (stock arrives at destination). Cancel while DRAFT.

Stock count



Create count, enter counted qty, Approve to write ADJUST movements. Cancel abandons the count.

Returns and notes



- Sales return (from a customer invoice) restores good stock and opens a draft credit note.
- Purchase return (to a vendor) reduces stock and opens a draft debit note.
- Note statuses: DRAFT -> ISSUED, or VOID.

Stock movements (item history screen)

Type	Examples
IN	GRN, transfer in, sales return (good), opening stock, found stock
OUT	Issue, challan dispatch, transfer out, purchase return
ADJUST	Manual adjust, stock count approval (damage / loss / correction / etc.)

4. Where you work

Stock	Balances, bulk issue, opening stock, barcode. Tap an item for its own history screen.
Items / Materials	Catalog (SKU, rate, GST, reorder). Material supplier tab says Materials.
Procurement	Indents / purchase requests, POs, GRNs, reorder suggestions.
Sales	Orders, quotes, challans, returns, notes. Includes counter sales from Issue.
Warehouse	Locations, transfers, stock counts.
Parties	Customers and vendors, price lists, ledgers.
Invoices / Bills	AR and AP. Confirm drafts created by Issue/dispatch or GRN.
Settings	Business profile, credit policy, PO thresholds, invites, Tally, reports.

5. Side-by-side

If you are choosing a profile, use this table. None of these rows change the status names.

Type	Wording	Typical sell path	Catalog flavour
Retail	Items	Issue first	Small-qty shop SKUs
Wholesale	Items	Issue and SO mix	Boxes / rims / cartons
Distribution	Items	SO + challan	Dealer / spare SKUs
Trading	Items	PO in, SO or Issue out	Kg / metre commodities
Material supplier	Materials / Indent	Issue (pickup) or SO (site)	Cement, steel, sand, bricks
Equipment	Items	SO + dispatch	High-value EQUIPMENT SKUs
General	Items	Either	Mixed / starting point

Company settings that are not types but change behaviour

- Credit limit policy: ALLOW (no check), WARN (toast, still creates invoice), BLOCK (reject if over limit).
- PO auto-approve below Rs X; owner must approve above Rs Y.
- Customer price lists override catalog rate on Issue and on sales orders.
- Multi-warehouse: dispatch/issue/adjust can target a store; transfers move between them.

Inventory product vs construction ERP

Inventory types (this PDF)	One hidden Main Store, inventory shell, no BOQ / projects / subcontracts.
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Construction

Projects, estimates, planning, RA invoices, work orders.

Do not mix

An inventory company cannot become construction ERP by changing profile.

6. Suggested walkthrough

- Log in as owner@hydmaterials.com (material supplier, richest demo) with Test@1234.
- Stock: open an item screen, then Issue a small qty - confirm the draft invoice, see the counter sale on Sales.
- Sales: New order -> Confirm -> New challan -> Dispatch - confirm the new draft invoice.
- Procurement: purchase request -> PO -> GRN -> Vendor bills.
- Settings: switch profile to Retail and refresh - tab says Items instead of Materials; statuses unchanged.
- Optionally log into owner@forgeequip.com or owner@cityhardware.com to see catalog flavour only.

Generated from the BuildFlow inventory product as implemented (shared engines, profile-based labels). Change the profile any time under Settings.